

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 13

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

- 25 Lack of trust on public functionaries and institutions erodes the foundations of democracy. Do you agree? Validate your arguments. (150 Words)
- 26 Except in authoritarian regimes, the support for socialist parties across the Globe is on decline. Discuss whether this phenomenon is due to the failure of the leadership or due to the failure of the concept of socialism itself. (250 Words)
- 27 What do you understand by Nationalism? How do you differentiate Nationalism and Ultra-nationalism? In recent times, why are these two terms being discussed often across the Globe? (250 Words)

GS – II ... CONSTITUTION AND POLITY

- 13 Examine how the Constitutional Framework ensured Independence of the Judiciary. In your opinion, what further measures are needed to strengthen the independence of the Judiciary? (250 Words)
- 14 “The judiciary acts as a pressure valve by standing between the State agencies and the resting population and absorbing all the heat and dust thrown up by the cycle of governances or due to lack of it”. Elaborate with recent examples. (150 Words)
- 15 Critically examine how far the “first-past-the-post electoral system” takes care the interests of the minorities and the vulnerable sections. Is there any need for change in the present system? Argue. (250 Words)



GS – III ... ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

- 19 “Energy Efficiency and Energy Security are sine qua non for attaining global standing for any nation”. Elaborate the statement. Enumerate various steps taken by the Government in recent times in this direction. (250 Words)
- 20 “Regional imbalances among the states can only be corrected by bridging the transformational capital deficit faced by some states”. Elaborate. In your opinion what steps are needed to make the disadvantageous states vibrant? (150 Words).
- 21 What is Monetary Transmission? Why is the reduction in Repo Rate not automatically translating into Monetary Transmission? Enunciate the steps required to be taken to ensure Monetary Transmission. (150 Words)

GS – IV ...ETHICS & INTEGRITY

- 37 Explain the Kantian concept of categorical imperatives in ethics. (150 Words)
- 38 Brief the recommendations of 2nd ARC to enable ethics in politics through political reforms. (250 Words)
- 39 Discuss the ingredients of an ideal work culture in an organization. (250 Words)

Lack of trust on public functionaries and institutions erodes the foundations of democracy. Do you agree? Validate your arguments. (150 Words)

Public functionaries and institutions like Election Commission (EC), CAG etc. enhance the credibility of representative democracy. Survival of healthy democracy depends on the independence, integrity and autonomy and people's trust on these institutions.

RECENT INCIDENTS AFFECTING PUBLIC TRUST



ADVERSE CONSEQUENCES

- Erodes public trust on democracy
- Discourages participatory governance as people are unwilling to participate in voting, government schemes etc.
- May lead to authoritarian rule
- Nation's growth and development are at stake
- Delivery of justice is hampered

CONCLUSION

State organs, especially judiciary, have to play a proactive role in upholding rule of law and supremacy of constitution. Of these, protecting independence and autonomy of public institutions is the need of the hour.

Except in authoritarian regimes, the support for socialist parties across the Globe is on decline. Discuss whether this phenomenon is due to the failure of the leadership or due to the failure of the concept of socialism itself. (250 Words)

Socialism is an ideology that promotes state ownership and control of the nation's resources. The fall of socialist states across the world is both leadership and ideology failure.

RECENT INCIDENTS

- Rise of conservative parties in USA, UK and France.
- Steady loss of voter support to socialist parties in Italy, Germany, Bolivia, Brazil etc. against non-delivery of welfare promises.
- Shift towards capitalism in India through LPG reforms.

REASONS FOR FALL OF SOCIALISM

- Leadership failure to move beyond statist state
 - ✓ Apart from China which embraced capitalist features, other states still have centralized control over social and economic affairs.
 - ✓ Fall of USSR to sustain the socialistic regime.
 - ✓ Failure of Venezuela to engender growth and development.



- Ideology is still stuck in Public/Private Binary
 - ✓ Issues of Public Vs Private ownership instead of opening to market.
 - ✓ Not in consistence with present day masses and consumerist culture.
- Services became dominant activity
 - ✓ Base of industrial workers for socialism has weakened.
 - ✓ Very few manufacturing-based companies among the largest corporations on stock exchange.
- Capitalism increased incomes
 - ✓ Absolute incomes have risen.
 - ✓ People under poverty line have decreased significantly.

CONCLUSION

Capitalism has marginalized socialism by its capacity of innovation. Socialism has to master the new forces of capitalism to fashion a credible response or perish.

27 / IS
GS - I

What do you understand by Nationalism? How do you differentiate Nationalism and Ultra-nationalism? In recent times, why are these two terms being discussed often across the Globe? (250 Words)

Nationalism is an ideology that unifies the people of a nation by promoting a strong sense of identity among them. Ultra-Nationalism involves not only love towards one's own nation but also hatred towards other nations.

NATIONALISM	ULTRA-NATIONALISM
Nationalism injects a sense of pride.	Ultra-nationalism is a threat to the "nation-state".
Forges National Integration by strengthening the "unity in diversity".	Shows the tendency of polarization or protectionism, which prevents National integration and gives rise to divisiveness.
Instigates scientific temper for technological advancement of the Nation.	Puts off logical and rational thinking.
Supports co-operative federalism by preventing regionalism and including the opposition.	Use of state machinery to suppress opposition.
Glorifies belongingness among people.	Any sort of dissent is stifled.



NATIONALISM	ULTRA-NATIONALISM
Promotes internal harmony and minority protection.	Supports the theory of John Mill- "TYRANNY OF MAJORITY": ✓ Suppression of minorities ✓ Rule of law is undermined by rule of men ✓ Blind Nationalism ✓ Autocratic /despotic/ authoritarianism
Provides emotional integration of nation along with territorial and constitutional integration.	Results in fears of collective threat to different sections of people.

REASONS FOR BEING DISCUSSED ACROSS THE GLOBE

- Recent power dynamics in states like Turkey signals the rise of dictatorial regime.
- Israel-Palestine developments and stifling of freedom of press across nations are indicators of emergence of ultra-nationalism.
- Protectionist measures of America in the name of America First Policy adversely affecting global trade.

FINALLY

Nationalism as an inclusive ideology is necessary for a nation state to achieve the targets of equitable growth and development. But ultra-nationalism is always antithetical to global peace and security.



13 / C&P
GS - II

Examine how the Constitutional Framework ensured Independence of the Judiciary. In your opinion, what further measures are needed to strengthen the independence of the Judiciary? (250 Words)

Independence of judiciary is part of basic structure of Indian Constitution. This is to ensure that the role of judiciary as guardian of Constitution is performed without any hindrances.

CONSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR JUDICIAL INDEPENDENCE



JUDICIAL INDEPENDENCE

NEEDS

Check the functioning of other organs of the State

Uphold rule of law and principle of separation of powers

Unbiased interpretation of Constitutional provisions

Neutral delivery of justice

Not compromise the quality of justice

CONCERNS

Opacity in judges appointment

Unconstitutionality of collegium

Autocratic nature of judges selecting judges

Nepotism in judiciary

Breaching the conventions of seniority in appointments

Delay in appointments despite vacancies

Merit not being prioritized in appointments

Judicial evasion in sensitive issues

MEASURES NEEDED TO STRENGTHEN THE INDEPENDENCE

- Restructuring collegium to remove subjectivity and inconsistency
- Amending NJAC to the extent of protecting judicial independence
- Written manual for procedure of appointments
- Transparency in all meetings similar to monetary policy committee of RBI
- Merit as basis for appointment to be incorporated

THE WAY AHEAD

Apart from reforming collegium, implementing All India Judicial Services through transparent selection process enhances the credibility along with independence of judiciary.

14 / C&P
GS - II

“The judiciary acts as a pressure valve by standing between the State agencies and the resting population and absorbing all the heat and dust thrown up by the cycle of governances or due to lack of it”. Elaborate with recent examples. (150 Words)

Judiciary is established as an intermediate body between people and legislature to keep the latter within the limits assigned to their authority. Further, it upholds the rule of law in times of political and executive vacuum.

RECENT EXAMPLES IN THIS CONTEXT

➤ AGAINST EXCESS OF GOVERNANCE

- Judgement on Aadhar Act
 - ✓ Invalidated sharing of data on ground of national security.
 - ✓ Private companies can't ask for Aadhar.
 - ✓ Restricted Aadhar to a few essential services.
- Floor tests in state legislature of Maharashtra, Uttarakhand etc.

➤ AGAINST LACK OF GOVERNANCE

- Mandating liquor prohibition along National Highways.
- Recommending Vishakha guidelines to prevent sexual harassment of women at workplace.
- MPs, MLAs to be disqualified on date of criminal conviction.
 - ✓ Lily Thomas Vs Union of India declared Section 8(4) of RPA, 1951 which allowed 3 months window to appeal against their conviction for MPs, MLAs as unconstitutional.
- Upholding right to cast negative vote under NOTA in EVMs.
- Right to Privacy as a fundamental right (Puttaswamy Vs Union of India).

CONCLUSION

Thus, Constitution acts as a wall to stand up to populist forces and protect constitutional ethos from being desecrated.



15 / C&P
GS - II

Critically examine how far the “first-past-the-post electoral system” takes care the interests of the minorities and the vulnerable sections. Is there any need for change in the present system? Argue. (250 Words)

In First-past-the-post system, each voter has one vote and a candidate is elected from a constituency if he/she receives the highest number of votes. There is no minimum threshold of votes that candidates are required to secure to win.

REASONS FOR INDIA ADOPTING FPTP

- For a country ravaged by sectarianism, stable government with majority in Lok Sabha was necessary to maintain law and order.
- Simple for Indian voters to understand, most of whom were illiterate.
- Proportional representation (PR) may give marginalized groups a mere voice in electing their representatives and not a definite quota ensured by reservation of seats.

FPTP – INTERESTS OF MINORITIES AND VULNERABLE SECTIONS

- Failed to ensure representation to minorities commensurate with their demographic share.
 - ✓ E.g.: Muslims, India's largest religious minority have dismal representation in Lok Sabha and State Legislatures.
- Resulted in majority rule than democracy exaggerating the share of seats of leading party.
- Minorities and vulnerable sections have no say in policies that affect them.
- No reservation of seats for religious minorities.



NEED FOR CHANGE

- FPTP even failed in establishing stable governments as evident in various coalition governments.
- Democracies like UK and Canada are embracing PR.
- Nepal chose hybrid electoral system combining FPTP and PR.
- India may combine FPTP system with PR. To realize this, increase in Lok Sabha seats by 25% which could be filled by PR while FPTP continues as usual (Law Commission Report, 2015).

THE WAY FORWARD

India must consider Ambedkar's suggestion that minorities must have representation in cabinet in proportion to their population. In the era of nation states, due share of power is necessary to empower their sections.

“Energy Efficiency and Energy Security are sine qua non for attaining global standing for any nation”. Elaborate the statement. Enumerate various steps taken by the Government in recent times in this direction. (250 Words)

India imports 80% of its oil needs and is the 3rd largest oil consumer in the world. Its consumption is expected to grow 4.5% every year for next 25 years. In this context, energy security and energy efficiency are necessary to sustain its growth and development against external disturbances.

CHALLENGES IN THE ENERGY SECTOR

POLICY CHALLENGES

- Failure to attract international investment in domestic hydrocarbon exploration
- Delay in coal mining due to regulatory and environmental clearances
- Failure in setting up foreign built nuclear reactors

ACCESSIBILITY CHALLENGES

- Biomass accounts for 90% of primary fuel consumption for cooking in rural areas
- Currently, 304 million Indians don't have electricity access

ECONOMIC CHALLENGES

- Inadequate domestic suppliers of coal, oil and natural gas and increasing import dependence
- Rising fuel subsidies



EXTERNAL CHALLENGES

- CAATSA and reduced oil imports from Iran
- US-China trade war and its spill overs

INITIATIVES TO ENHANCE ENERGY SECURITY

- Increasing accessibility to clean energy
 - ✓ Electricity to every household by 2022
 - ✓ Solar irrigation pump distribution on agriculture front
 - ✓ PM Ujjwala Yojana to bring clean fuel in rural areas
- Policy changes
 - ✓ Shift from NELP to HELP for exploration of hydrocarbon sources
 - ✓ Shift toward electric mobility by 2024
 - ✓ National Mission on Biofuels
 - ✓ Strategic Petroleum Reserves at various locations
- Promotion of renewable energy
 - ✓ 175 GW of renewable energy by 2022
 - ✓ KUSUM for greater adoption of solar energy
- Infrastructure
 - ✓ Gas distribution network as part of Urja Ganga

INITIATIVES TO ENHANCE ENERGY EFFICIENCY

- National Mission for enhanced energy efficiency aims to strengthen market for energy efficiency
- Shift from BS-IV to BS-VI norms by 2020
- Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) to give star rating to appliances
- ECONIWAS – Energy efficient building code developed by BEE

CONCLUSION

With increasing environmental challenges, future energy security will be redefined. Dynamic scenarios foreseen by NITI Aayog's India Energy Security Scenarios, 2047 should guide India's energy policy.



“Regional imbalances among the states can only be corrected by bridging the transformational capital deficit faced by some states”. Elaborate. In your opinion what steps are needed to make the disadvantageous states vibrant? (150 Words).

Transformational capital deficit is the additional capital required to transform the State by generating growth accelerating infrastructure. By this, the States can overcome their historical infrastructure deficit and improve on developmental parameters to keep in pace with the leading States. Finance Commission failed to address this demand of States due to its inherent structural limitations.

VERTICAL IMBALANCES

Arose due to

Greater share of tax revenue to Centre, but, greater responsibilities to State Governments.

Which are taken care by Finance Commission as mandated by the Constitution.

HORIZONTAL IMBALANCES

Arose due to

Differential growth rates and development status of different States.

Partly addressed by Finance Commission. However, the issue of lack of transformational capital remains.



STEPS NEEDED TO MAKE THE DISADVANTAGEOUS STATES VIBRANT

- NITI Aayog can be delegated the responsibility of transformational intervention.
- Provide resources of about 1% to 2% of GDP from State and Central GST to NITI Aayog to realize this intervention and reduce inter regional imbalances.
- Seriousness should be accorded to the 73rd and 74th Constitutional amendments.
- The missing local finance must be looked at.
- Create an Urban Local Body's / Panchayati Raj Institution's Consolidated Fund.
- Amendment of Articles 266/268/243H/243X to ensure that relevant monies flow directly into the Consolidated Fund of the third tier.

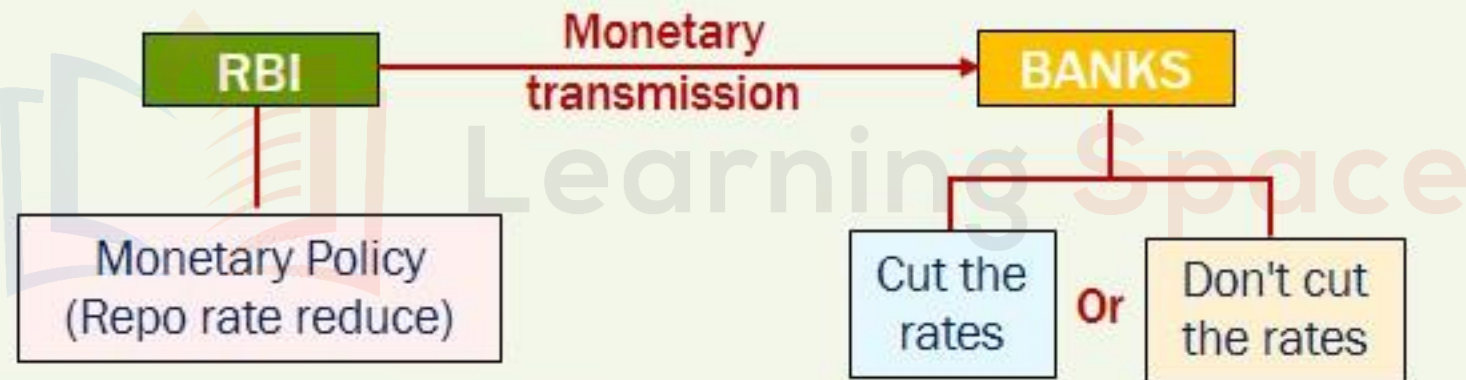
THE WAY AHEAD

India's goal of achieving \$5 economy by 2024-25 needs growth of at least 8 to 9%. This calls for balanced growth and development of all states. Enhancing State specific capabilities through co-operative federalism is the need of the hour.

21 / ED
GS - III

What is Monetary Transmission? Why is the reduction in Repo Rate not automatically translating into Monetary Transmission? Enunciate the steps required to be taken to ensure Monetary Transmission. (150 Words)

Monetary transmission is the concept whereby RBI's rate cut actions should pass on to the economy at large. Financial institutions like banks should also cut their rate proportionally, and pass on the benefit to people.



BOTTLENECKS IN ACHIEVING MONETARY TRANSMISSION

- BANK FUNDS ARE LOCKED
 - ✓ Double financial repression: Pressure on banks due to locking of funds in Government Securities (SLR) and Cash Reserves (CRR)
 - ✓ Priority Sector Lending
 - ✓ Higher Provisioning
 - ✓ Objective is to comply with BASEL-III norms thus fulfilling CRAR (Capital Risk Asset Weighted Ratio)



▪ INCREASING NON-PERFORMING ASSETS

- ✓ Bank's balance sheet is already in stressed situation

▪ SUB-OPTIMAL PERFORMANCE OF MCLR SYSTEM

- ✓ To streamline the base rate, Marginal Cost of Lending Rate (MCLR) was envisaged. But, as per Janak Raj Committee, this system did not yield desired results.
- ✓ Since most of the public savings are in bank deposits, it reduces the bank's dependency on repo rate.
- ✓ No deepened bond market for long term financing.
- ✓ Procedural bottlenecks in recovery of dues by banks coupled with large borrowings by the government.
- ✓ High average cost of deposits.
- ✓ Non-interest operating expenses.

STEPS TO ENSURE MONETARY TRANSMISSION

- Mandating banks to link all loans to external benchmarks like repo rate etc.
- Deepening bond markets for long term financing.
- Ensuring efficient credit appraisal system.
- Streamlining asset resolution by reducing delays.
- Quick bank recapitalization based on performance indicators to strengthen balance sheets.
- Preventing further evergreening of NPAs.
- Incentives and penalties-based nudge towards monetary transmission.

CONCLUSION

India is a developing market taking proactive measures to create a robust financial infrastructure. Enabling effective monetary transmission would not only increase the credibility of central bank but also help in strengthening the financial structure.



Explain the Kantian concept of categorical imperatives in ethics. (150 Words)

Kant's Categorical Imperatives – Immanuel Kant believed that there are set moral obligations that one must follow and these moral obligations are to be derived from pure reason. Such moral obligations are called Categorical Imperatives. Two essential features of the categorical imperatives are:

▪ **Universalizability Principle**

- ✓ Moral obligation must be universal without any contradiction. Everyone's reason should permit and accept an obligation as moral. Then only it can be called as categorical imperative.

▪ **Formula of Humanity**

- ✓ Moral obligation should treat all humans as ends in themselves but not as means to achieve those ends.
- ✓ As long as an action is considered moral by everyone by virtue of one's reason and the action treats humans as ends, but not means, such an action can be treated ethical.
- ✓ E.g.: Suppose a person is hungry and steals bread, it is immoral because stealing is not approved by human reason. Similarly, in cases of human trafficking and slavery, humans are objectified and treated as just means. Hence, human trafficking and slavery are regarded as immoral.

CONCLUSION

Thus, for Kant, categorical imperative is a measuring rod to assess the ethicality of an action. Accordingly, even killing a criminal or even a terrorist is also not moral since killing does not appear to be moral to anyone's reason.



Brief the recommendations of 2nd ARC to enable ethics in politics through political reforms. (250 Words)

As Gandhi said, politics without principles is a sin. To ensure moral and ethical politics, necessary evidence based political reforms have to be a continuous process for every state. The political reforms as mentioned by 2nd ARC are:

Learning Space

POLITICAL REFORMS - RECOMMENDATIONS

- **POLITICAL FUNDING**

- ✓ *Recommendation:* A system for partial state funding should be introduced in order to reduce the scope of illegitimate and unnecessary funding of expenditure of elections.

- **TIGHTENING OF ANTI-DEFECTION LAW**

- ✓ *Recommendation:* The issue of disqualification of members on grounds of defection should be decided by the President/Governor on the advice of the Election Commission.



POLITICAL REFORMS - RECOMMENDATIONS

▪ **DISQUALIFICATION**

✓ *Recommendation:*

- Disqualify all persons facing grave and heinous crime charges from representing the people in legislature.
- All false declarations made before the Returning Officer should be made an electoral offence.

▪ **COALITION ETHICS**

✓ *Recommendation:*

- If one or more parties in a coalition with a common programme, re-align midstream with one or more parties outside the coalition, then the members of the party shall have to seek a fresh mandate from the electorate.

▪ **EXPEDITING DISPOSAL OF ELECTION PETITIONS**

✓ *Recommendation:*

- Special Election Tribunals with a mandate to dispose of Election Petitions within a period of six month should be set up.

CONCLUSION

These political reforms have to be simultaneously accompanied by socio-economic reforms and change in attitudes and behaviours of both people and political parties.



Discuss the ingredients of an ideal work culture in an organization. (250 Words)

Every organization believes in specific ways of interaction, behaviour and functioning which form its work culture. This is instilled and sometimes even imposed on all the members of organization. It includes:

- **Innovation and Risk taking**
 - ✓ Whether an organization encourages employees to try new ways;
 - ✓ whether an organization tolerates the failure resulting from trying new ways and so on.
- **Attention to detail**
 - ✓ Whether members of an organization are expected to be specific even about the minute things
- **Outcome orientation**
 - ✓ Whether an organization is just concerned about the results or it is concerned about the methods involved in realization of those results
- **People orientation**
 - ✓ Whether the organization worries about the impact of its policies, decisions on the members of an organization



- **Team orientation**

- ✓ Whether the tasks are assigned to individuals or to teams

- **Necessary amenities**

- ✓ Whether the organization providing necessary amenities to establish a healthy eco-system

- **Aggressiveness**

- ✓ Whether the members of an organization are competitive and always on toes to finish off the tasks

- **Stability**

- ✓ Whether the organization believes in status quo or in growth

CONCLUSION

If all the members of an organization have the same opinion about the organization and its principles, then the organization has a strong culture; if the members differ in their opinion about the organization, then that organization has a weak culture.

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